

UMER SOHAIL

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, University of Delaware, Newark, DE Exp. Jan 2027
 Fields: International Trade, Development Economics, Applied Microeconomics
M.S. Economics and Applied Econometrics, University of Delaware, Newark, DE May 2024
B.Sc. (Honors) Economics, Minor in Mathematics, LUMS, Lahore, Pakistan May 2021

JOB MARKET PAPER**The Impact of Trade Liberalization on Manufacturing Firms: Evidence from Pakistan**

with Zehra Farooq (FBR, Pakistan) — Draft, October 2025

We study how manufacturing firms adjust to improved export-market access under the European Union's GSP+ agreement, which sharply reduced tariffs on Pakistani exports. Using administrative tax records linked to firm-level tariff exposure, we find substantial heterogeneity by baseline productivity: more productive firms expand capital investment and maintain employment, while less productive firms contract wage bills without reinvestment. Liberalization reallocates resources toward productive incumbents through within-firm restructuring rather than selection out of the market.

WORKING PAPERS**Causal Impact of Barter Trade Policy during a Foreign Exchange Reserves Crisis**

with Fraz Ahmed (Carnegie Mellon University) — Draft, December 2025

When Pakistan's foreign exchange reserves collapsed in 2023, the government introduced a barter mechanism allowing goods-for-goods trade with Afghanistan, bypassing frozen banking channels. Using transaction-level customs data and product-level variation in barter eligibility, we show barter-eligible products experienced 30% higher export quantities during the crisis peak. Effects emerged during reserve depletion and dissipated as payment systems resumed, demonstrating that temporary interventions can sustain trade during payment system failures without persistent distortions.

Towards Win-Win: Evidence from Commercial Dispute Resolution in India

with Manaswini Rao, Sandhya Seetharaman, and Raghav Pandey — Draft, November 2025

We leverage the random assignment of commercial and contractual cases to judges in newly established commercial courts in India to examine the impact of judge-led mediation on case outcomes and litigating firms' profits. We estimate a large, positive effect of judge settlement-propensity on the profitability of plaintiff firms. Defendants experience a negative effect around the timing of suing, but settlement reverses this trend, pointing to potential Pareto improvements from expedited dispute resolution.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE**Teaching Fields:** Macroeconomics, Econometrics, Development Economics, International Trade**Instructor of Record**, University of Delaware, Newark, DE

Principles of Macroeconomics (26 students, online/asynchronous) Summer 2026
 Economic Issues and Policies (45 students, online/asynchronous) Winter 2026

Teaching Assistant — Graduate Level, University of Delaware, Newark, DE

Econometric Theory Spring 2024
 Microeconomic Theory I Fall 2023

Teaching Assistant — Undergraduate Level, University of Delaware, Newark, DE

Development Economics Spring 2025
 Banking and Monetary Policy Fall 2024

Teaching Assistant , Lahore University of Management Sciences (LUMS), Lahore, Pakistan	
Mathematics of Finance	Fall 2021
Mathematical Applications in Economics	Spring 2021
Macroeconomics	Fall 2020
Econometrics	Spring 2020
Intermediate Microeconomics	Fall 2019

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant , University of Delaware (Prof. Manaswini Rao)	June 2024 – Present
Applied judge IV strategy to estimate causal effects of judicial decisions on firm outcomes; built reproducible pipelines merging court records with firm financial data in Stata and R.	
Research Assistant , University of Delaware (Prof. Nisha Chikhale)	June – August 2025
Constructed longitudinal PSID panel for causal policy analysis; built full replication files.	
Research Assistant , University of Manchester, Manchester, UK	July – August 2021
Extracted and cleaned administrative tax records for quasi-experimental policy research.	

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

AI Automation Consultant , TeamLift	September 2025 – July 2026
Designed and deployed AI workflow automations and agent-based systems for client organizations, translating large language model tools into measurable efficiency gains across teams.	
Data Researcher , Unison Infrastructure	August 2021 – July 2022
Built geospatial data pipelines integrating satellite imagery and administrative records into structured datasets supporting infrastructure investment decisions; developed workflows for data quality checks, record linkage, and operational reporting.	

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Sally Latham Graduate Research Award, University of Delaware	2026
Dean’s Honour List, LUMS	2018 – 2021
Graduated with Distinction, LUMS	2021

CONTINUED EDUCATION

Graduate Teaching Assistant Training, University of Delaware	2024, 2025
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SKILLS

Software: Stata, R, Python, SQL, L ^A T _E X, Git, Excel
Methods: Causal Inference, Quasi-Experimental Design, Instrumental Variables, Difference-in-Differences

REFERENCES

Adrienne Lucas (Chair)	Parag Mahajan	Manaswini Rao	Shafaat Yar Khan
Associate Professor of Economics	Assistant Professor of Economics	Assistant Professor of Economics	Assistant Professor of Economics
University of Delaware	University of Delaware	University of Delaware	Syracuse University
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